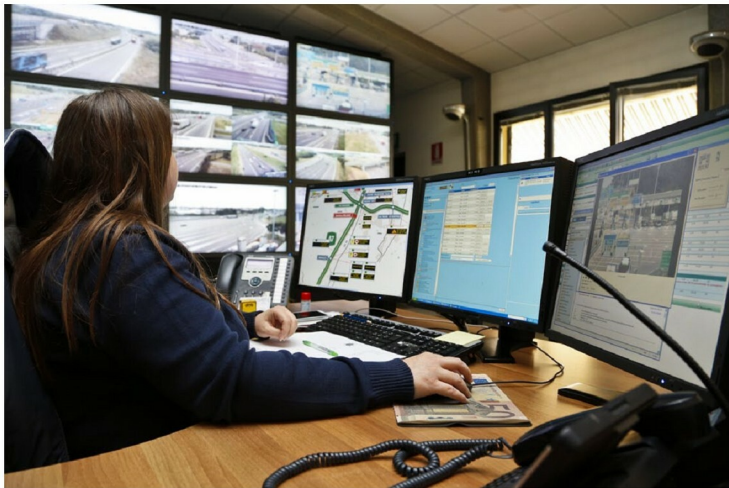


Installing and Configuring Nagios Core on Linux

Here's a comprehensive guide on the Nagios network and system monitoring software application, which covers the installation and configuration of Nagios Core on a Linux system. It also includes the creation of custom Nagios plugins using the Bash script.



A network monitoring system is an essential constituent of any enterprise, small or large. A substantial amount of money is spent on establishing the entire network infrastructure, mainly servers and network components, expanding it as per changing needs and most important, keeping it alive all the time. With the network infrastructure constantly growing, it becomes a tedious job for network and systems administrators to continuously keep an eye on every device, all the time. Hence, there's a need for a network monitoring system that does this job for them.

A network monitoring system can show the live statuses of all the devices - whether they are up or down, the resources being consumed by them, services running on them, etc - in one place. Moreover, it notifies the administrators immediately in case of a malfunction by sending them emails,

SMSs or even phone calls, so that admins are always aware of what has gone wrong and at which point in the network.

When it comes to selecting the best monitoring tool, there are many alternatives to choose from, but Nagios is one of the finest options. It is available in two versions - Nagios Core, which is open source and free, and Nagios XI, which comes with some added features and capabilities, but needs to be purchased. However, both deal with monitoring critical servers and network devices, both provide indications of problematic situations, and both report the issues to the admins through mails and/or messages to help minimise downtime, reduce commercial losses and improve SLA.

This article is about installing and configuring Nagios Core on a Linux system. To demonstrate this, I have used the framework mentioned below.